



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 08

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Jigsaw & Reciprocating Saw Safety

OVERVIEW:

Jigsaws and reciprocating saws are used for curved cuts, cutouts, and demolition work that other saws cannot reach. The blade is exposed and the cut direction can change unexpectedly. Most injuries occur when the free hand is too close to the blade or when the tool contacts a hidden hazard inside the

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Before cutting into any wall, floor, or ceiling with a reciprocating saw, scan the area for hidden utilities. Electrical wires, plumbing lines, and gas pipes run inside wall cavities and can be contacted without warning. Use a stud finder, wiring detector, or thermal camera when available. Call your supervisor before cutting into any area where utilities are suspected but not confirmed.
2. Your free hand needs to be well away from the blade at all times during any jigsaw or recip saw operation. Never use your free hand to steady the work directly in line with the blade path. Use clamps to secure the workpiece. If the workpiece is too small to clamp and you must hold it, position your hand to the side of the cut line and far from the blade exit point on the bottom of
3. Blade selection matters for both safety and cut quality. Using a wood blade for demolition work — where nails, screws, or embedded metal are likely — will cause the blade to break suddenly at high speed. Always use an appropriate bi-metal or demolition blade for unknown material. A broken blade can cause serious lacerations and is startling enough to cause a loss of control of the tool.
4. Never start a blade inside an existing hole or slot where it could bind on the startup stroke. The sudden torque at startup in a confined space can wrench the tool sideways and cause loss of control. Instead, drill a starter hole large enough to insert the blade before starting the saw, or start the cut from the edge of the material and work to the interior.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: How do you confirm a wall is clear of utilities before cutting into it on this project?
Q2: What types of blades do we have available, and how do you choose the right one?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Never start a blade inside a cut that could bind on startup
- Keep your free hand well away from the blade at all times
- Scan for hidden utilities before cutting into walls or floors
- Use the correct blade — wood blades in wood, not demo blades
- Secure small pieces before cutting; never hold them freehand

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 08

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
01		click to sign	16		click to sign
02		click to sign	17		click to sign
03		click to sign	18		click to sign
04		click to sign	19		click to sign
05		click to sign	20		click to sign
06		click to sign	21		click to sign
07		click to sign	22		click to sign
08		click to sign	23		click to sign
09		click to sign	24		click to sign
10		click to sign	25		click to sign
11		click to sign	26		click to sign
12		click to sign	27		click to sign
13		click to sign	28		click to sign
14		click to sign	29		click to sign
15		click to sign	30		click to sign